

COVER LETTER GUIDE

Your Name
Your Address

Date

Contact Person's Name, Title
Company Name
Company Address

Dear Mr./Ms. _____:

Begin by explaining the reason you are contacting the employer/recruiter (that is, you are interested in the _____ position) and how you learned about the job opening (for example, indicate the source of the information, including name of the newspaper, publication, or website). Immediately state **why your background makes you the best candidate for the position you are applying for**. Keep the first paragraph short and hard-hitting.

This is your Match-Making Paragraph. Referring to your resume, detail **what you can contribute to this company with specific emphasis on experience, education, skills, and qualifications developed that will benefit the company based on the job description**). Make as strong a match possible and provide extra qualities that will be of added benefit to the company/organization. This paragraph along with your resume should be a strong reflection of the actual job description. Remember to summarize and not list what the employer is seeking in a candidate.

Describe why you specifically want to work for this employer using your researched information and industry knowledge. At a minimum visit the company website and learn **their mission/vision statement, about us, history, core values, press releases, etc.** **Passionately connect to something you are very interested about the company** and clearly show how by assisting the employer in reaching their goals it will also help you in reaching your own career goals. Employers tend to look for candidates who can present a strong win-win situation for both parties.

In the closing paragraph, you should specifically request an interview. Include your email and phone number and the hours you can be reached. Express your interest in receiving a response from the employer/recruiter, and how their consideration in your request for an interview will be greatly appreciated. Remember to keep this letter short; few employers will read a cover letter over one page.

Sincerely,

Your Signature

Your full name typed

Encl: resume
